
Detailed unit content

Topic C Do TV and video games affect young people's behaviour?

1. Explaining the question: Do TV and video games affect young people's behaviour?

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a causes of aggression including:
 - i biological (limbic system and amygdala, hormones)
 - ii social learning including from TV and video games (Social Learning Theory: role models, vicarious reinforcement, modelling, observational learning, identification)
- b biological and social learning explanations of aggression by comparing them, including an evaluation of each
- c the nature-nurture debate in relation to understanding aggression
- d the evidence for individual differences in aggression drawing on Ramirez et al (2001) and Anderson and Dill (2000).

In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

2.

Investigating the question: content analysis

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the following terms, and their use when referring to methodology:
 - i sampling and generalisability issues in a content analysis
 - ii identifying categories and tallying
 - iii reliability of content analysis

In examination, students could be asked to design a content analysis from stimulus material, drawing on the terms above.

- b the ethical issue of protection of participants and how this may be dealt with
- c the aims, procedures and findings (results and/or conclusions) and evaluation of
 - i Anderson and Dill (2000) *Video games and aggressive thoughts, feelings and behaviour in the laboratory and in life*
 - ii Ramirez et al (2001) *Cultural and sex differences in aggression*
 - iii Charlton et al (2000) *Children's playground behaviour across five years of broadcast television: a naturalistic study in a remote community*
 - iv Williams (1981) *How and what do children learn from television.*